

Kerala Travel Guide

Overview

Kerala, on India's southwestern coast, is known as 'God's Own Country' for its backwaters, hill stations, beaches, and Ayurvedic wellness tourism. Popular circuits include Kochi, Munnar, Alleppey (Alappuzha), and Thekkady.

Best Time to Visit

September to March offers pleasant weather (20-30 degrees Celsius), ideal for houseboat stays and sightseeing. Monsoon season (June-August) is popular for Ayurvedic treatments, as the humidity is considered beneficial for certain therapies, though outdoor plans may be disrupted by rain.

Top Attractions

Alleppey Backwaters - overnight houseboat cruises through canals and paddy fields.

Munnar - tea plantations, misty hills, and Eravikulam National Park (home to the Nilgiri Tahr).

Fort Kochi - colonial architecture, Chinese fishing nets, and a vibrant art scene.

Thekkady (Periyar Wildlife Sanctuary) - boat safaris and spice plantation tours.

Varkala Beach - dramatic cliffs overlooking the Arabian Sea, popular for its laid-back vibe.

Local Transport

KSRTC buses connect major towns reliably. Houseboats are booked in advance for Alleppey/Kumarakom backwaters. Auto-rickshaws and app-cabs are common within cities; hill routes to Munnar are best done by pre-booked taxi due to winding roads.

Local Guidelines

Kerala follows strict alcohol sale timings through government-run outlets (Bevco/Consumerfed).

Modest clothing is expected when visiting temples; some temples restrict entry to Hindus only.

Always confirm Ayurvedic treatment credentials at a certified centre before booking.

Approximate Costs

Budget travellers can manage on Rs. 1800-2500 per day. A one-night houseboat stay in Alleppey ranges from Rs. 6000 (shared/budget) to Rs. 15,000+ (premium, AC, private). Munnar homestays are typically Rs. 2000-4000 per night.